VISION 2030: HEALTH DEPARTMENT RECEIVES IDEAS

Rajasthan 2030: Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot's Vision for Development

- Collaboration among the Departments of Medical and Health, Medical Education, and Ayush
- Orientation of over 6.72 lakh personnel and stakeholders towards the vision document
- Involvement of Asha Sahayoginis, ANMs, Mahila Arogya Samiti members, Swasthya Mitras, Doctors, and CHOs
- Accumulation of numerous suggestions from 60 meetings at the division and district levels

A state-level workshop, chaired by Health Department Additional Chief Secretary Smt. Shubhra Singh, convened participants from villages, blocks, districts, and divisions via video conferencing. Chief Secretary Smt. Usha Sharma highlighted the emerging positive outcomes from the collaborative efforts of these three departments. She emphasized that Rajasthan is currently gaining recognition nationally and internationally as a Model State. Smt. Singh acknowledged the remarkable progress in medical and health made by Rajasthan over the last five years. Formerly categorized as a "sick state" (BIMARU), Rajasthan has successfully emerged from this classification. Now, the focus is on working with unwavering dedication and commitment to achieving the mission's goals. She stressed the importance of considering every relevant suggestion to guide the state's healthcare journey towards 2030. She underscored that the real competition is with themselves, and all sections and categories are actively engaged in the consultation process.

Rajasthan State Health Assurance Agency (RASHAA) CEO Smt. Shuchi Tyagi explained that the program's objective is to incorporate all received suggestions and inform the public about the nature of these recommendations. Dr. Sudhir Bhandari, Vice Chancellor of Rajasthan University of Health Sciences (RUHS), emphasized the need to extend tertiary services to smaller towns. He noted that healthcare services in America and Europe are not only expensive but also entail long waiting times for appointments. In contrast, Rajasthan now offers angiography facilities in every district.

Dr. Sandeep Jasuja, Medical Superintendent of the State Cancer Institute, highlighted the state's commitment to providing free cancer medications, including costly immunotherapy drugs, under the leadership of Chief Minister Shri Ashok Gehlot. Dr. Vishwakarma, a member of the World Health Organization (WHO), stressed that Vision 2030, much like the organization, places significant emphasis on participation and collaboration.

CAMPAIGN FOR PURITY: SHUDH KE LIYE YUDH

ENSURING SAFE AND NUTRITIOUS FOOD FOR ALL



Everyone deserves safe and quality food that provides value for money. Food items must be nutritious and of high quality. Stringent measures need to be taken against adulteration, and those responsible should face consequences. In January 2022, the Ashok Gehlot-led government in Rajasthan launched the “Shudh ke liye Yudh” campaign to combat adulteration. This initiative followed the establishment of the Directorate of Food Safety. This strategic move aimed to create strong regulations for the campaign and enforce strict penalties for adulterators.

The campaign is not limited to a short period but is a continuous effort. To ensure effective coordination, the Directorate of Food Safety and the Department of Drug Control were merged and integrated into this campaign. This synergy allows for scientific analysis of adulteration based on data from both departments. This information helps assess the extent of adulteration and its potential impact on health. These reports play a pivotal role in prosecuting offenders in court. Eradicating adulteration requires resolute action against those responsible.

The establishment of a commissionerate has boosted the sampling of food items. In the past, around 6,000 samples were collected annually until 2021-22. However, the number of food inspections rose to 13,577 in 2022-23. Under the Food Safety Act, over 14,000 samples and 1,926 surveillance samples were taken, totalling 15,977. This campaign introduced commodity-based checks, covering items such as vegetable oils, milk products, packaged drinking water, fruits, vegetables, bakery goods, and spices.

Gehlot government approved 7 new Public Health Food Laboratories. The building for laboratory has been built at Sikar, Baran, Barmer, Nagaur, and Sriganganagar. It is being said that the laboratory will be completed by the end of September in Bhilwara and Dholpur. With this, Rajasthan will become the first state to have a large number of laboratories for food safety. Beside this 25 new mobile laboratories has been set up so that at least one mobile laboratory has started functioning in each district.

RAJASTHAN'S FOOD SAFETY REVOLUTION:
FROM LABS TO INFORMERS, A HOLISTIC CAMPAIGN

To sustain this ongoing campaign, a significant increase in staff was necessary. The state government approved the creation of 398 posts for Food Safety Officers, and the recruitment